LEAVE POLICY

INTRODUCTION:

Leave is a privilege extended by the Company to its Employees, and not a right. It shall be the Company's discretion to grant leave to all applicant employees, considering the exigencies of business and the need of the Employee at that time.

The objectives of this Leave Policy are, to inform all employees of the company, regarding: -

a. The current rules on the types of leave and their eligibility.

b. Administration and Accounting of leave.

c. Guidelines for Applicants, Granting Authorities, and Administrative Authorities.

The said leave policy is subject to change from time to time, following the Company's business objectives.

PURPOSE:

To communicate the rules and regulations and modes of application of leave to all the concerned employees.

OBJECTIVE:

We recognize and respect employees' needs for leave time away from work. The Company strives to create and maintain a balanced work schedule for its employees and promotes quality of life through its varying leave programs.

All permanent employees both full-time and part-time are eligible to receive leave. Temporary employees and employees undergoing probation periods are not eligible to receive leave time with pay from the Company.

This Policy encourages its employees to take a break from work as this is essential for the health and efficiency of the Employees. The leave policy sets out the various types of leaves that an employee is eligible for and outlines the procedure for availing of the same.

LEAVE OUTLINE:

- ***Leave year*** is calculated from 1st Jan – 31st Dec of each year.
- ***Sanctioning of leave*** is solely at the discretion of the Management and decision concerning the same based on exigencies of business or the seriousness of the case.
- The different ***types of leaves*** covered under this policy are:
    - Casual Leave (CL)
    - Sick Leave (SL)
    - Earned Leave (EL)
    - Public Holiday
    - Restricted Holidays (RH)
    - Loss of pay (LOP)
    - Compensatory Off
- Every employee will be entitled to the following leaves:

1. CASUAL LEAVE

- **Objective:** To attend to personal exigencies arising out of unforeseen circumstances.
- **Eligibility:**
    - All Employees shall be eligible for **12 days** of casual leave in every calendar year.
    - In the case of Employees who join the Company during the calendar year, the amount of casual leave shall be prorated.
    - Casual leave cannot be availed for less than half a day or more than 2 days at a time. Casual leave at a stretch beyond two days shall be treated as absent without leave or Loss of pay.
    - Holidays and weekly off days occurring during the period of Casual leave shall be counted as part of the leave.

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- Casual leave cannot be combined with any other type of leave. If an Employee takes casual leave and thereafter falls ill requiring sick leave the entire period shall be converted into sick leave.

- All consultants and probationers are eligible for Casual leave of 1 day for every completed month of employment, subject to a maximum of 12 days of Casual Leave per year.

- **Accumulation:** Casual leave is non-cumulative and also non-encashable. Casual leave which has not been availed shall automatically lapse at the end of every calendar year.

- **Administration**:

  - Employee must obtain prior sanction before proceeding on casual leave. When this is not possible, they shall as soon as practicable, inform their reporting manager of their inability to attend duty, giving reasons thereof, and should obtain approval through the prescribed application form immediately on resuming duty.

  - Grant of casual leave shall be subject to exigencies of business and the discretion of the leave sanctioning authority.

2. SICK LEAVE

- **Objective:** To provide rest during the recovery of Employees from sickness.

- **Eligibility:**

  - Employee shall be eligible for **12 days** of sick leave (inclusive of casual leave) in a calendar year.

  - Sick leave shall be prorated in the first and last year of service

  - Sick leave applications for more than 5 days must be supported by a certificate from a Registered Medical Practitioner.

  - Holidays and weekly off days occurring during the period of sick leave shall be counted as part of the leave.

- **Accumulation:**

  - Accumulation of sick leave is permissible up to 12 days.

- Sick leave which is accumulated can be availed only after due application for the same is made by the Employee and special approval granted by the Reporting Head.
- Sick leave is not encashable.

➢ **Administration:**

- Employee absent from duty on account of sickness must immediately notify their immediate superior of their absence due to illness.
- Immediately on resuming duty, the Employee must submit the leave application along with the medical certificate and fitness certificate issued by a registered medical practitioner.
- Sick leave is a contingency leave and can be availed only when an Employee is disabled due to illness from performing his/her day-to-day duties. Sick leave should not be treated as a substitute for casual leave. Availing sick leave for purposes other than genuine sickness amounts to malingering, which shall be dealt with appropriately by the Reporting Lead/immediate superior.
- Accumulated Sick leave shall be granted only in emergency cases after full Casual Leave/Earned leave of the applicant for the current year has been exhausted.
- The Company reserves the right to obtain a second medical opinion in respect of an Employee who is found to be availing sick leaves frequently without sufficient grounds or any noticeable illness.

3. Maternity Leave (as per the Maternity Policy)

4. Public Holidays

As declared every year, including but not limited to Pongal, Republic Day, Independence Day, Gandhi Jayanti, May Day, Diwali, and Christmas.

5. Restricted Holidays

➢ **Objective:** To attend religious festivals of their choice from the list of restricted holidays declared by the company every year.

- **Eligibility:**
    - All Employees shall be eligible to avail special casual leave on 2 restricted holidays per year.
    - Employees have to apply for special casual leave one week in advance to avail of a Restricted Holiday.
    - A Restricted Holiday List will be promulgated by the company along with the public holiday list, every year.
- **Accumulation:**
    - Restricted Holidays cannot be accumulated & encashed. Restricted holidays that are not availed shall automatically lapse at the end of every calendar year.
- **Administration:**
    - Employee must obtain prior CL approval before proceeding on RH.
    - Grant of RH shall be subject to exigencies of business and the discretion of the leave sanctioning authority.

6. EARNED LEAVE (12 DAYS)

This is designed to give the employees vacation periods for rest and to provide time off for personal needs.

- **Eligibility:**
    - All permanent employees are eligible to avail of earned leave after completion of 2 years of employment at the Company.
    - Earned leave is calculated for a period of one calendar year (Jan- Dec).
- **Entitlement:**
    - 12 days earned leave is allowed for each employee. Out of 12 days of leave credited for the year, any unpaid paid leave over 10 days at the end of the year will lapse automatically.
- **Norms:**
    - Holidays and weekly off may be prefixed or suffixed with Earned Leave.

- Holidays and weekly off falling during the period of leave will be counted as leave.
- The maximum unit of availing EL would be 5 days at a stretch.

➢ **Encashment:**

- Earned Leave can be encashed at the end of the calendar year. The overall limit on encashment is 10 days only.

➢ **Procedure:**

- All the employees are required to submit a leave plan to their respective head of the department stating when he/she intends to take paid leave.
- Employees should apply for leave in the prescribed format, 5 days in advance to his/her departmental head. Prior approval of earned leave is mandatory.
- All leave will be sanctioned by the departmental head and sent to the HR department for records.

7. LOSS OF PAY (LOP)

- LOP can be applied by all employees, even employees under probation period when no other leave is available.
- During the period of LOP, the employee is not entitled to any pay or allowance.
- LOP can be implicated on disciplinary grounds concerning attendance by the management regardless of the availability of the other types of leave.
- Sudden holidays will not be considered EL and if sick and casual leaves have been exhausted then such leave will result in loss of pay.

8. COMPENSATORY OFF

- If an employee is required to work on any important assignment on a National / Festival / Declared / weekly off day, he is eligible for Compensatory off on any other working day.
- Official approval is required from the department head/management to work on such National / Festival / Declared / weekly off days. No

compensatory offs will be entertained when an Employee works on these days without proper approval.

- The compensatory off has to be availed within three months from the date worked.
- Compensatory off when not availed within the stipulated period will lapse.
- Only two days of compensatory offs can be combined and availed at a stretch.

Miscellaneous

- Any employee found misusing the leave policy may be subject to disciplinary action.
- In case of any conflict or ambiguity in the leave policy, the decision of the HR department will be final.
- The company reserves the right to amend or modify the leave policy at any time to align with business needs and legal requirements.

CHANGE LOG:

Version	Date	Author	Section	Change Description
1.0	15-05-2020	HR	Overall	Release of the Leave Policy for this financial year.
1.1	13-08-2024	HR/Balaji	Overall	Release of the Leave Policy for this financial year.

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